

```

        if path.exists():
            contents = path.read_text()
            username = json.loads(contents)
            return username
        else:
            ❷ return None

def greet_user():
    """Greet the user by name."""
    path = Path('username.json')
    username = get_stored_username(path)
    ❸ if username:
        print(f"Welcome back, {username}!")
    else:
        username = input("What is your name? ")
        contents = json.dumps(username)
        path.write_text(contents)
        print(f"We'll remember you when you come back, {username}!")

greet_user()

```

The new function `get_stored_username()` ❶ has a clear purpose, as stated in the docstring. This function retrieves a stored username and returns the username if it finds one. If the path that's passed to `get_stored_username()` doesn't exist, the function returns `None` ❷. This is good practice: a function should either return the value you're expecting, or it should return `None`. This allows us to perform a simple test with the return value of the function. We print a welcome back message to the user if the attempt to retrieve a username is successful ❸, and if it isn't, we prompt for a new username.

We should factor one more block of code out of `greet_user()`. If the username doesn't exist, we should move the code that prompts for a new username to a function dedicated to that purpose:

```

from pathlib import Path
import json

def get_stored_username(path):
    """Get stored username if available."""
    --snip--

def get_new_username(path):
    """Prompt for a new username."""
    username = input("What is your name? ")
    contents = json.dumps(username)
    path.write_text(contents)
    return username

def greet_user():
    """Greet the user by name."""
    path = Path('username.json')
    ❶ username = get_stored_username(path)
    if username:
        print(f"Welcome back, {username}!")

```